

How to check for and enable virtualization

Introduction

In order for AccessMod to run on a PC with Windows, you need to have allowed virtualization on your machine. On new computers, virtualization is done automatically. However, on older computers, this might not be supported or you might have to turn this feature on. Knowing if virtualization is supported or the procedure to turn this feature on will depend on the processor used in your computer (Intel or AMD processor).

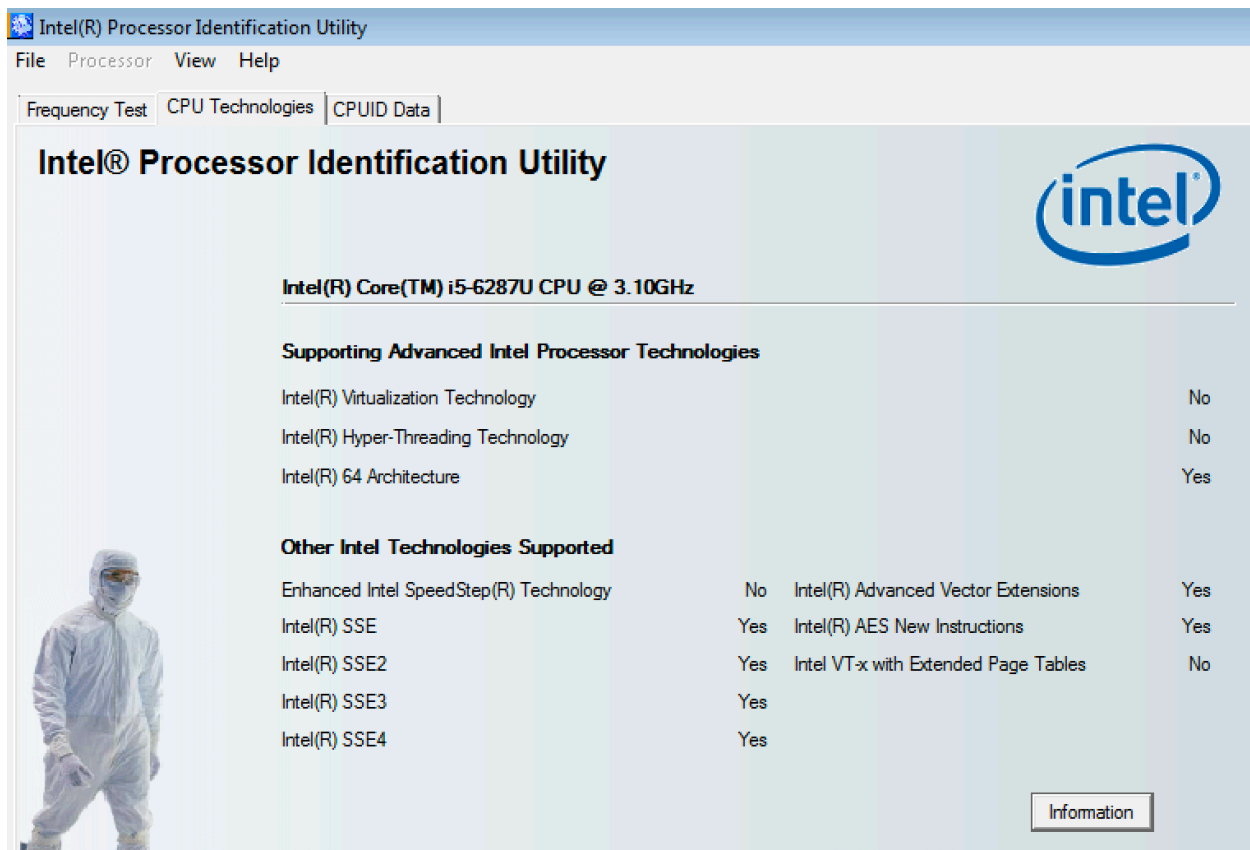
You will find below a few steps that should allow you to check the virtualization status of your machine and to set it up yourself. In case it is beyond your competence, ask your IT manager (or the AccessMod workshop facilitator if you are following such a workshop) to help you with setting this up.

How to check which type of processor and Windows version that is installed in my computer?

- 1) Click on the **“Start”** button that launches your Windows menu
- 2) Right-click on the **“Computer”** menu and select **“Properties”**
- 3) Under the **“System”** section, you will see the processor’s name and version
- 4) Under the **“Windows edition”** section, you will see the Window’s version

How to check if virtualization is supported in case I have an intel processor?

- 1) Go to <https://downloadcenter.intel.com/download/7838>
- 2) Make sure that your processor appears in the list of products listed, as well as the Windows version used on your computer
- 3) Download the utility (called “pidenu47.msi” on the left side) in your favourite language
- 4) Install the software on your computer (!!! In order to install a software, you need to have the administrator rights; if it is not the case, ask your system administrator!!!)
- 5) Run the sotware “Intel® Processor Identification Utility” you just installed, from the start menu
- 6) When it opens, 3 tabs are available; select the tab “CPU technologies”



- 7) You can directly see under “Intel Virtualization Technology” if it is supported or not. If it is supported and already activated, you can go ahead and follow the AccessMod installation procedure.

If it is supported but not activated, please refer to the section “If virtualization is supported by my computer but not activated, how shall I activate it?”

If it is not supported, you can unfortunately not use AccessMod on your computer, and should request a computer that supports virtualization for using AccessMod.

How to check if virtualization is supported in case I have an AMD processor?

- 1) Download the utility software from http://download.amd.com/techdownloads/AMD-VwithRVI_Hyper-V_CompatibilityUtility.zip
- 2) Unzip it and extract the files in a specific folder
- 3) Run the “amdvhyperv” file to launch the program. !!! You need to run it as administrator, by right-clicking on it and clicking “Run as administrator”

You should then find the information if your AMD processor supports or not the virtualization.

If it is supported and already activated, you can go ahead and follow the AccessMod installation procedure.

If it is supported but not activated, please refer to the section “If virtualization is supported by my computer but not activated, how shall I activate it?”

If it is not supported, you can unfortunately not use AccessMod on your computer, and should request a computer that supports virtualization for using AccessMod.

If virtualization is supported by my computer but not activated, how shall I activate it?

In order to enable virtualization in your computer if this is supported, you need to enter the Bios of your machine to activate it. To access the bios of your computer, you will need to turn it off and to restart it. When it is booting, you will need to press a specific key combination at the very beginning of the booting process, before Windows is booting.

Common keys to enter the BIOS are F1, F2, F10, DEL, ESC, as well as key combinations like CTRL + ALT + ESC or CTRL + ALT + DEL but this varies depending on the computer brand, model and the motherboard. Generally, the key or key combination to press appears on the screen (e.g. F2). If nothing appears, the right moment is generally when manufacturer logos are displayed, prior to the booting of the operating system.

Here are the common key combinations by brand:

- **Acer:** generally F2 or delete. On older computer: F1 or CTRL+ALT+ESC
- **Asus:** generally F2, otherwise Delete or Insert or F10
- **Dell:** generally F2, otherwise F1, Delete, F12 or F3. On older models CTRL+ALT+ENTER or Delete or Fn+ESC or Fn+F1
- **HP:** generally F10 and ESC. On some computers F1, F2, F6, or F11
- **Lenovo:** generally F1 or F2. On older computers: CTRL+ALT+F3 or CTRL+ALT+INS or Fn+F1
- **Sony:** generally F2 or F3, but sometimes F1
- **Toshiba:** generally F2, but sometimes F1, ESC, F12.

The following URL will give more details: <https://www.lifewire.com/bios-setup-utility-access-keys-for-popular-computer-systems-2624463>

Once in the bios, it will be necessary to find the place where virtualization can be activated, set it to “activated” or “yes”, save it and exit from the bios.

After that, your computer should be able to run AccessMod.